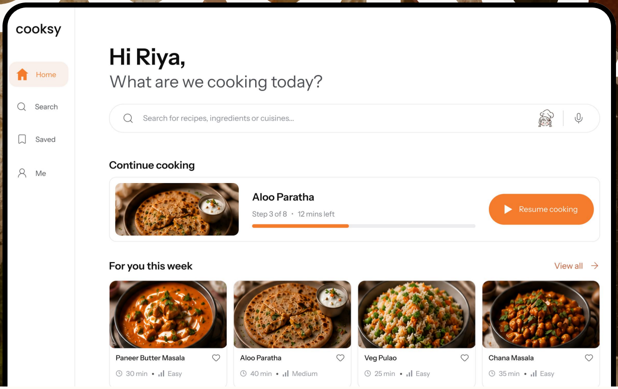
Cooksy



Hi Riya,
What are we cooking today?

Search for recipes, ingredients or cuisines...

Continue cooking

Aloo Paratha
Step 3 of 8 · 12 mins left

For you this week

Paneer Butter Masala	30 min	Easy
Aloo Paratha	40 min	Medium
Veg Pulao	25 min	Easy
Chana Masala	35 min	Easy

Aditi Chaware
ADT23IODB0119

Understanding the brief

The challenge is to transform a conventional tablet recipe experience into a hands-free Cook-Along Mode.

The key constraints are

1 **Legibility**

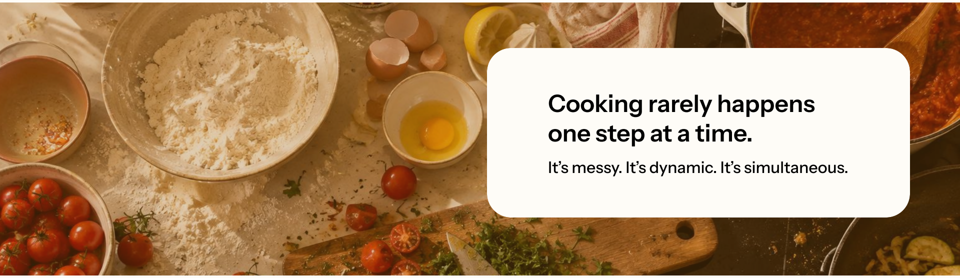
The interface should work from a 3–5 ft viewing distance.

2 **Minimal-touch interaction**

Enable hands-free recipe interaction while cooking.

3 **Cognitive load**

Manage multiple timers and ingredient scaling without clutter.



Cooking rarely happens one step at a time.

It’s messy. It’s dynamic. It’s simultaneous.

The moment cooking begins,
interacting with a touchscreen becomes a secondary task.

Day 1

Brief · Context · Secondary Research · Competitors · User Research

Day 2

Synthesis · Persona · Journey · Problem · HMW · Ideation · Wireframes

Day 3

UI · Interactions · Prototype · Testing · Iterations · Final Polish

Secondary Research

What do cooking apps look like today?

Recipe apps are built for discovery first

Recipe apps focus on discovery and planning; cooking often becomes a separate mode.

“Cook Mode” simplifies the recipe

Cooking apps use step-by-step layouts, larger text, timers, and highlighted ingredients.

Multiple timers are becoming important

Some cooking apps allow several timers to run simultaneously because cooks may be preparing multiple components at once.

Cooking apps are getting better at guiding the cook
but the cooking environment remains messy, distracted and unpredictable.

Competitor Analysis

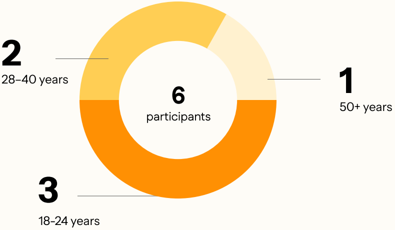
What do existing cooking experiences get right and where do they break down in the real kitchen?

Feature	**Cookd**	**Sanjeev Kapoor Recipes**	**Cookpad**	**Samsung Food**
Core strength	Step-by-step cooking	Guided cooking and chef expertise	Community recipes	All-in-one food ecosystem
Step-by-step	✓	✓	✓	✓

Timers	✓	✓	—	✓
Recipe scaling	—	✓	—	✓
Video guidance	✓	✓	✓	—
Hands-free / AI guidance	—	**AI + guided cook-along**	—	**AI-guided recipes**
Indian relevance	**High**	**High**	**High**	Medium
Biggest opportunity	Strong cooking flow	Strong guided experience	Human/community content	Broad ecosystem

User Research

Understanding real cooking experiences



Semi-structured interviews explored cooking habits, recipe-following challenges and multitasking.

The conversations also uncovered the emotional side of cooking, including family bonding and passing down traditional recipes.

Where users find recipes

Here's what users have to say

"I understand recipes better through videos, but I'm constantly pausing and replaying them to keep up."

"It was easier learning from my grandma. I could watch her and ask questions as many times that I wanted to."

Following a recipe isn't always as easy as it looks.

"When I'm cooking multiple things, it's easy to lose track of timings or forget what I was doing."

"I often have to stop mid-step to prep missing ingredients, then figure out where I left off."

"I keep going back to the recipe website to check what's next. It breaks my flow, and I end up washing my hands over and over just to use my phone."

Key Insights

1

Recipe following interrupts cooking flow

Repeatedly pausing videos or revisiting websites disrupts the cooking process.

2

Messy hands create friction

Accessing instructions often means washing and rewashing hands.

3

Recipes don't always match real-time needs

Cooks need instructions that adapt to their pace and preparation, not just a fixed sequence.

4

Cooking is both functional and emotional

People value not only convenience but also the personal connection of learning recipes from family.

User Persona

Who Are We Designing For?

Riya Sharma
The Independent Cook

Goals & Needs

- Follow recipes without losing her place
- Coordinate preparation and cooking steps
- Spend less time checking her phone

Pain Points

- Constantly pausing and replaying videos
- Washing hands to navigate recipe websites
- Missing steps while preparing ingredients

Tasks

- Quickly check current and upcoming steps
- Manage timers and reminders
- Adjust servings and ingredient quantities

“I just want to follow a recipe without constantly stopping what I’m doing.”

Meera Kulkarni
The Traditional Learner

“Learning from my grandmother felt different. I could watch, ask questions, and learn by doing.”

Goals & Needs

- Learn and recreate traditional family recipes
- Understand techniques, not just measurements
- Preserve family cooking knowledge

Pain Points

- Online recipes often lack practical context
- Videos don't always explain why a step matters
- Written instructions can feel impersonal

Tasks

- Follow instructions with clear technique cues
- Save and organize family recipes
- Add personal notes and cooking tips

Key pain points & opportunities

Every cooking frustration reveals an opportunity to make the experience smoother, more intuitive, and more enjoyable.

01

Users pause videos or revisit recipe websites to check the next step. → Make instructions accessible without interrupting the cooking flow.

02

Touching devices means stopping to clean or wash hands. → Enable hands-free recipe interaction while cooking.

03

Cooks can lose their place when switching between preparation and recipe instructions. → Keep the current step and upcoming actions easy to follow.

04

Online recipes may lack the practical cues and personal tips people learn from family. → Support helpful technique cues and personal recipe notes.

Problem Statement

Home cooks often struggle to follow digital recipes while cooking, as messy hands and repeated checks interrupt their flow.

They need a seamless, hands-free experience that makes instructions easy to access while managing multiple cooking tasks.

Design Challenge

How might we help home cooks follow recipes effortlessly, without interrupting their cooking flow or having to touch their devices?

Design Goals

1. Hands-free interaction
   Enable recipe navigation without touching the screen.
2. Glanceable instructions
   Make steps easy to read from 3–5 feet away.
3. Seamless multitasking
   Help cooks manage multiple timers and ingredient scaling without clutter.
4. Uninterrupted flow
   Keep cooks focused on preparing food with minimal disruption.
5. Personal connection
   Preserve the tips and techniques that make family recipes meaningful.

Design Principles

Four principles shaping the Cook-Along experience.

1

Glanceable

Prioritize the information that matters in the moment.

2

Hands-free

Let cooks stay focused on the food, not the device.

3

Contextual

Surface the right guidance at the right time.

4

Forgiving

Make it easy to recover, repeat, and continue.

Make cooking easier without taking away what makes it meaningful.

Ideation

Finding my direction

Must have

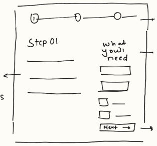
- Hands-free recipie navigation
- Large, readable instructions
- Step by step
- progress indicators
- Timers (multiple if possible)

Should have

- Voice based
- replay instruction without touching screen
- Short video instructions
- quick access to ingredient quantities.

Could have

- Family recipie notes
- Personal cooking tips
- cook-together experiences.
- personifying cooking assistant
  ↓
  wormth, familiar feel.

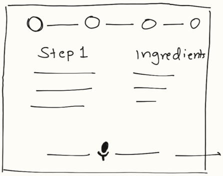


Progress indicator

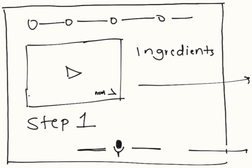
list of ingredients

large text instructions

X still need to press next button
↓
not possible with messy hands.



use audio to give instructions
↓
next / repeat



step by step video instructions

voice commands as well as buttons for better flexiblity.

How might we
add that personal
touch and familiarity?

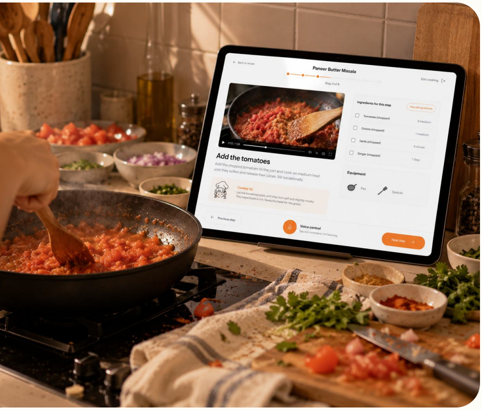
* Family recipe notes
  - like ur mom likes to add.... or grand ma's trick...
* Tone + familiar voice

* The cooking buddy
  - Personal agent helping you cook.
    (agentic ai?)

Wireframes

Introducing Cooksy

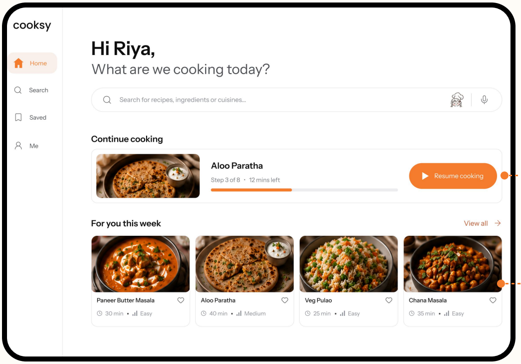
Your hands-free cooking companion.



Cooksy is a voice-first cooking experience that combines step-by-step video guidance, glanceable instructions, ingredient access, and multiple timers in one interface.

A friendly, personality-driven cooking buddy adds warmth through contextual tips and reassuring prompts, helping home cooks navigate recipes hands-free while staying focused on the cooking itself.

Final Screens



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Home

Discover & Resume

1 **Continue cooking**

Resume an unfinished recipe with progress saved.

2 **Personalised suggestions**

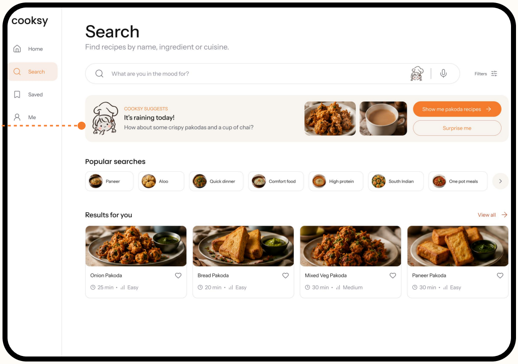
Recipe cards tailored to the user.

Search

Contextual Discovery

1 **Cooksy suggests**

Context-aware ideas, such as pakodas on a rainy day.



Search

Find recipes by name, ingredient or cuisine.

COOKSY SUGGESTS

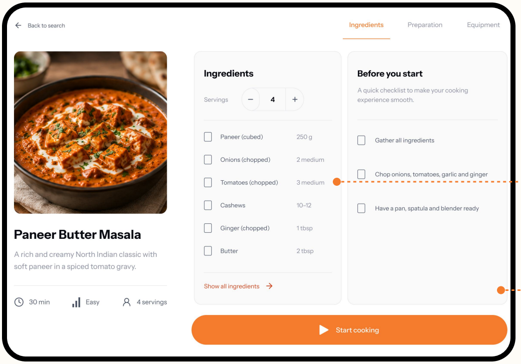
It's raining today!

How about some crispy pakodas and a cup of chai?

Popular searches

Results for you

Recipe	Time	Difficulty
Onion Pakoda	25 min	Easy
Bread Pakoda	20 min	Easy
Mixed Veg Pakoda	30 min	Medium
Paneer Pakoda	30 min	Easy



Paneer Butter Masala

A rich and creamy North Indian classic with soft paneer in a spiced tomato gravy.

30 min · Easy · 4 servings

Ingredients

Servings − 4 +

	Ingredient	Amount
☐	Paneer (cubed)	250 g
☐	Onions (chopped)	2 medium
☐	Tomatoes (chopped)	3 medium
☐	Cashews	10–12
☐	Ginger (chopped)	1 tbsp
☐	Butter	2 tbsp

Before you start

A quick checklist to make your cooking experience smooth.

☐ Gather all ingredients
☐ Chop onions, tomatoes, garlic and ginger
☐ Have a pan, spatula and blender ready

Recipe Details

A preparation overview helps users organise ingredients and equipment before starting.

1 **Ingredient checklist**

Review quantities and adjust serving sizes.

2 **Pre-cooking checklist**

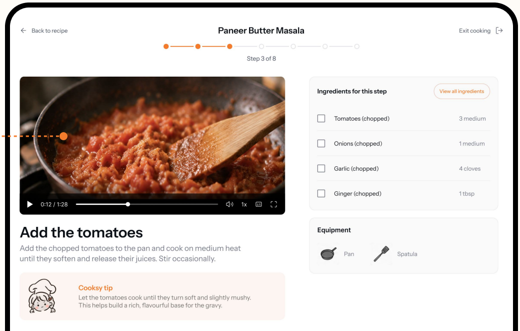
Gather ingredients, prep vegetables and ready equipment.

Active Cooking

A focused cooking view presents the current instruction alongside relevant ingredients and visual guidance.

1 **Step-by-step guidance**

Video and clear instructions for the current action.



Paneer Butter Masala

Step 3 of 8

Add the tomatoes

Add the chopped tomatoes to the pan and cook on medium heat until they soften and release their juices. Stir occasionally.

Cooksy tip

Let the tomatoes cook until they turn soft and slightly mushy. This helps build a rich, flavourful base for the gravy.

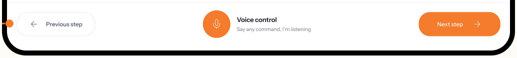
Ingredients for this step

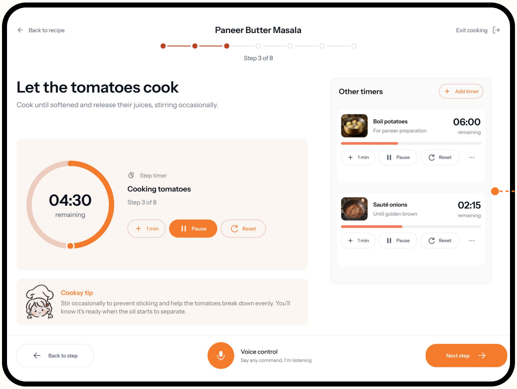
	Ingredient	Amount
☐	Tomatoes (chopped)	3 medium
☐	Onions (chopped)	1 medium
☐	Garlic (chopped)	4 cloves
☐	Ginger (chopped)	1 tbsp

Equipment

2 Flexible controls

Voice commands, repeat and on-screen navigation.





Let the tomatoes cook

Cook until softened and release their juices, stirring occasionally.

Cooksy tip

Stir occasionally to prevent sticking and help the tomatoes break down evenly. You'll know it's ready when the oil starts to separate.

Timer Mode

A dedicated timer view helps users manage cooking durations without losing track of the active recipe step.

1 Multiple timers

Track parallel cooking tasks in one place.

Cooksy Buddy

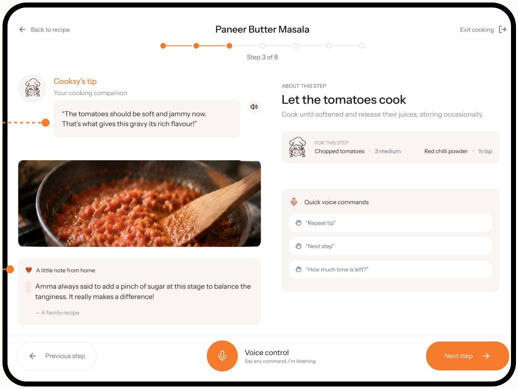
Cooksy adds a friendly layer of guidance with contextual tips and familiar cooking notes.

1 Contextual tips

Helpful cues about texture, timing and technique.

2 Personal touch

Surface saved family tips alongside the active step.



"The tomatoes should be soft and jammy now. That's what gives this gravy its rich flavour!"

ABOUT THIS STEP

Let the tomatoes cook

Cook until softened and release their juices, stirring occasionally.

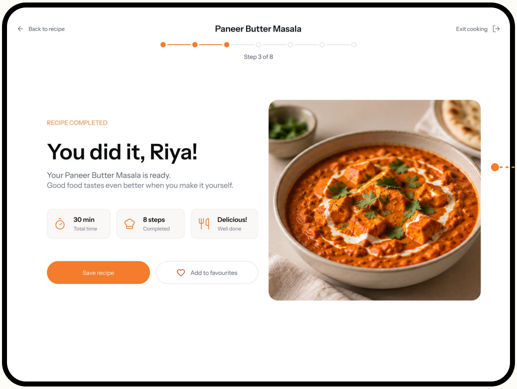
FOR THIS STEP

Chopped tomatoes · 3 medium Red chilli powder · ½ tsp

A little note from home

Amma always said to add a pinch of sugar at this stage to balance the tanginess. It really makes a difference!

— A family recipe



You did it, Riya!

Your Paneer Butter Masala is ready.
Good food tastes even better when you make it yourself.

30 min Total time	8 steps Completed	Delicious! Well done

Recipe Complete

Celebrate & Save

1 **Positive reinforcement**

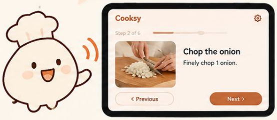
A warm message recognises the user's effort.

Hands-free interaction flow

Use simple voice commands to navigate, repeat instructions or start timers while cooking.

1 Say a command

“Next step”

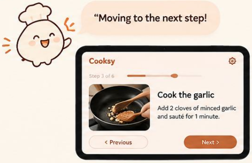


Chop the onion
Finely chop 1 onion.

Speak a command, such as “Next step” while cooking.

2 Cooksy responds

“Moving to the next step!



Cook the garlic
Add 2 cloves of minced garlic and sauté for 1 minute.

Cooksy advances to the next instruction and updates the progress.

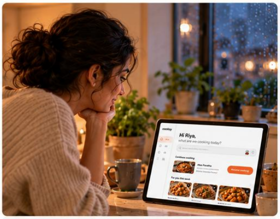
3 Other useful commands

“Repeat that”	Cooksy repeats the current instruction.
“Start a 5-minute timer”	A labelled timer starts while the recipe remains accessible.
“Go to ingredients”	Cooksy navigates to the requested section.

On-screen controls remain available as a fallback for users who prefer to tap.

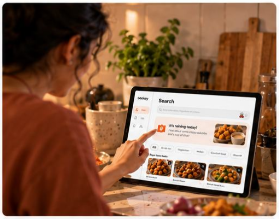
Storyboard

Riya’s Journey with Cooksy



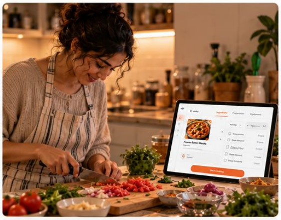
01 **Riya decides what to cook**

It’s a rainy evening and Riya opens Cooksy on her tablet to find something delicious for dinner.



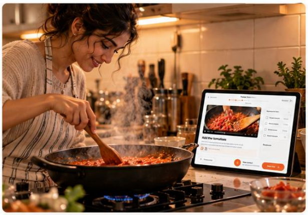
02 **Riya gets a personal recommendation**

Cooksy suggests pakodas and chai because it’s raining. Riya likes the idea and selects a recipe.



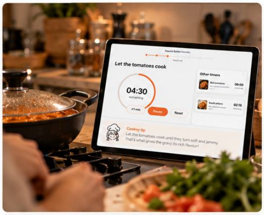
03 **Riya prepares before cooking**

Riya checks the ingredients and preparation steps, gathers everything and taps Start Cooking.



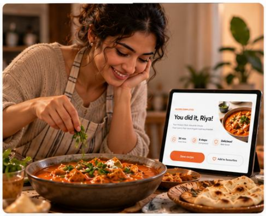
04 **Riya cooks without interruption**

With messy hands, Riya follows the step on the tablet and says “Next step” to move forward.



05 **Riya gets helpful guidance**

Cooksy runs a timer and gives a useful cooking tip while the tomatoes simmer.


You did it, Riya!

06 **Riya feels a sense of achievement**

Riya finishes cooking, sees a warm message from Cooksy and saves the recipe for later.

User Validation

What did users think of Cooksy?

> I like that I don't have to keep touching the screen while cooking. Saying ‘next step’ would make things much easier when my hands are messy.

> Having the timer and the other cooking tasks in one place is helpful. I often forget about something simmering while I prepare the next thing.

> The little cooking buddy makes it feel less like following a manual. I'd love it even more if I could add tips from my mum's recipes.

> I like that the app tells me what I need to do before I get started. Now, I don't feel overwhelmed in the middle of a recipe.

Learnings

1. Context-driven design
   Design for the user's real environment, not just the screen.
2. Information hierarchy
   Prioritise essential information to reduce cognitive overload.
3. Design within constraints
   Explore creative solutions for hands-free interaction and glanceable interfaces.
4. Function meets emotion
   Combine practical utility with personal touches to create meaningful experiences.

Limitations

1. Limited validation
   Small sample size limits generalisability.
2. Voice interaction
   Needs testing in noisy kitchen environments.
3. Technical feasibility
   Core features require functional testing.

Thank You